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AMC AERIAL PORT EXPEDITOR (APEX) AIRCRAFT LOADING PROGRAM

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This instruction implements Department of the Air Force Policy Directive (DAFPD) 24-6, *Distribution and Traffic Management*. It establishes guidance and procedures for the Aerial Port Expeditor (APEX) Program. This instruction is applicable to HQ AMC/A3V, APEX APS/AMS units, deployed APEX locations and maintenance personnel. It does not apply to the Air National Guard, the Air Force Reserve Command, or the United States Space Force. Ensure all records created as a result of processes prescribed in this publication are maintained in accordance with Air Force Instruction (AFI) 33-322, *Records Management and Information Governance Program*, and disposed of in accordance with Air Force Records Information Management System Records Disposition Schedule, which is located in the Air Force Records Information Management System. Refer recommended changes to this instruction to the office of primary responsibility (OPR) using the DAF Form 847, *Recommendation for Change of Publication*. Route DAF Forms 847 from the field through the appropriate functional chain of command. Supplements to this publication are not authorized. The authorities to waive wing/unit level requirements in this publication are identified with a Tier **(T-2)** number following the compliance statement. See Department of the Air Force Manual (DAFMAN) 90-161, *Publishing Processes and Procedures*, for a description of the authorities associated with the Tier numbers. Submit requests for waivers through the chain of command to the appropriate Tier waiver approval authority through HQ AMC/A4TC. The use of the name or mark of any specific manufacturer, commercial product, commodity, or service in this publication does not imply endorsement by the Air Force.

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Chapter 1

PROGRAM DEFINITION

1.1. Aerial Port Expeditor (APEX) Program. APEX is an Aerial Port workload management tool which provides Aerial Port Leadership the flexibility to determine the best time to on/offload an aircraft, based on duty schedule and air flow. APEX Load Directors are authorized to supervise the on/offload of cargo on C-17/C-5 aircraft without the presence of a Loadmaster.

1.2. Formal Courses. Load Directors attend a two-week formal course taught by instructors from the USAF Expeditionary Operations School (USAF EOS) at Joint Base Charleston, South Carolina and Joint Base Lewis-McChord, Washington (C-17) or Travis Air Force Base, California (C-5). Immediately following the formal (classroom) course, a 30-hour hands-on training class will be conducted/available on the respective aircraft.

1.3. Responsibilities. Load Director responsibilities on the C-17 aircraft consist of operating cargo door and ramp, aircraft stabilizer struts, aircraft winch and oversight of on/offloading operations. Load Director responsibilities on the C-5 aircraft consist of operating the aircraft winch and oversight of the front and aft door on/offloading operations. Load Directors are responsible for all loading operations in accordance with (IAW) technical orders, Air Mobility Command Instructions (AMCI) and related guidance. Maintenance will provide support for all C-5 door and ramp operations. APEX personnel are not qualified to load cargo rigged for airdrop and Prime Nuclear Airlift Force (PNAF) designated missions.

Chapter 2

PROGRAM ADMINISTRATION RESPONSIBILITIES

2.1. Administrative Authority. HQ AMC/A4 has overall authority over the APEX program.

2.1.1. **HQ AMC/A4T, Air Transportation Division** , is the overall OPR which develops and publishes procedures for the APEX program IAW HQ AMC/A4 delegated responsibilities.

2.1.1.1. **Waiver Authority.** HQ AMC/A4T is the singular waiver authority for the APEX program. Send requests for waivers with appropriate justification to HQ AMC/A4TC. HQ AMC/A4TC evaluates and monitors requests and will assign control numbers for approved waivers. **(T-2)**

2.1.1.2. The intent of requesting, controlling, and monitoring of waivers at HQ AMC level is twofold. To provide flexibility to units when conditions prohibit full compliance with this instruction. To monitor trends in waiver requests so standards can be adjusted or revised to provide maximum service to AMC units with minimum impact on AMC resources. **(T-2)**

2.1.2. **HQ AMC/A4TC, Air Cargo Movement Policy Branch.**

2.1.2.1. Provides program oversight and manages the program as directed by HQ AMC/A4T. HQ AMC/A4TC will:

2.1.2.2. Formulate procedures and guidance, analyze deficiencies, and solve problems.

2.1.2.3. Maintain HQ AMC/A4TC Cargo Policy Branch APEX SharePoint™ page.

2.1.2.4. Conduct staff assistance visits as needed or when requested by the Unit commander, of each unit's APEX program for the expressed interests of improving readiness or compliance performance.

2.1.3. **Technical Support.**

2.1.3.1. HQ AMC/A3V, Aircrew Standardization Evaluation Division, is the designated aircraft loading process owner.

2.1.3.2. HQ AMC/A3V Loadmasters will provide cargo loading guidance, procedures, and unit STAN/EVAL support.

2.1.3.3. HQ AMC/A4M, Directorate of Logistics, Engineering and Force Protection, Maintenance Division, will provide oversight and procedures for maintenance support.

2.1.4. **Program Location Selection.**

2.1.4.1. HQ AMC/A4T will designate APEX Aerial Ports based on the below factors. In all cases, units must restrict expansion of the program beyond what is operationally maintainable and feasible. Factors that must be considered include:

2.1.4.1.1. Frequency, schedule, and number of originating missions (C-17, C-5).

2.1.4.1.2. Unit manpower capability to support a home station APEX program.

2.1.4.1.3. Ability of the unit to maintain APEX currency.

2.1.4.1.4. Number of in-transit missions remaining overnight.

2.1.4.1.5. Availability of maintenance to support APEX operations.

2.1.4.1.6. Home station aircraft assigned (C-17, C-5).

2.1.5. **APEX locations (Subject to change):** Dover AFB, DE (C-17/ C- 5); Joint Base Charleston, SC (C-17); Joint Base Elmendorf- Richardson, AK (C-17); Joint Base Lewis-McChord, WA (C-17); Joint Base McGuire-Dix-Lakehurst, NJ (C-17); Joint Base Pearl Harbor-Hickam, HI (C-17/C-5); Kadena AB, Japan (C-17); Ramstein AB, Germany (C-17/C-5); Travis AFB, CA (C-17/C-5); and Yokota AB, Japan (C-17).

2.1.6. APEX is not authorized to be performed at any non-APEX designated location. The listed locations in **paragraph 2.1.5** are the only approved APEX locations. Load Directors will not be sent Temporary Duty (TDY) assignment or deployed to perform APEX functions without prior coordination from HQ A4T. Refer to **Chapter 9** for the process.

2.1.7. **Workshop organizing.**

2.1.7.1. HQ AMC/A4TC will organize biennial APEX workshops to coincide with the revision/revalidation of this publication and applicable checklist.

2.1.7.2. **Workshop participation.** The following organizations are highly encouraged to participate in APEX workshops: HQ AMC/A4T, HQ AMC/A4M, HQ AMC/A3V, USAF EOS, Unit Program Managers, Unit Stan/Evals, and hands-on training instructors from Joint Base Charleston, SC; Joint Base Lewis-McChord, WA; and Travis AFB, CA.

2.1.7.3. If funds are not available to travel, workshops will be conducted via videoconference or teleconference.

Chapter 3

TRAINING

3.1. Management. HQ AMC/A4TS, Standardization and Resources Branch, is OPR for APEX training development and management. HQ AMC/A4TS will:

3.1.1. Evaluate APEX training/curriculum.

3.1.2. Coordinate with USAF EOS on all course development and scheduling of formalized training through the Instructional System Development process.

3.1.3. Coordinate training requirements and material with HQ AMC/A4TC and HQ AMC/A3V.

3.1.4. Coordinate with AFIMSC/A35S on training allocations and/or training waiver requests.

3.2. Formal Classroom Training. USAF EOS will:

3.2.1. Conduct/provide formal classroom instruction/training to enable APEX student understanding of C-5 and C-17 aircraft loading principles (separate courses). Principal instruction will be provided, not task certification.

3.2.2. In coordination with HQ AMC/A4TS, develop and maintain APEX loading program lesson plans and test questions, as required.

3.2.3. Provide Mobile Training Team (MTT) capability.

3.2.4. Create/control/maintain refresher tests.

3.2.5. Coordinate test questions with HQ AMC/A4TC and HQ AMC/A3V.

3.3. Hands-on Training. Immediately upon completion of the two-week formal training course, APEX students will attend/complete the one-week (30-hour) hands-on training. This training consists of C-17 or C-5 preflight principles/techniques, cargo winch procedures and cargo systems operations. Additionally, the C-17 training will include cargo door, cargo ramp and stabilizer struts operations. Unit APEX Load Director Instructors at 437 APS Joint Base Charleston, SC; 62 APS Joint Base Lewis McChord, WA (C-17); and 60 APS Travis AFB, CA (C-5) will facilitate the hands-on training. The hands-on instructors will:

3.3.1. Provide qualified APEX Load Director Instructors to conduct all hands-on training.

3.3.2. Develop and maintain a hands-on training syllabus approved by HQ AMC/A4TC.

3.3.3. Coordinate an aircraft with host base maintenance. Request maintenance trainers, ground trainers, and/or static aircraft to meet timeline requirements. **Note:** Contact HQ AMC/A4TC as soon as possible if an aircraft cannot be obtained.

3.3.4. Notify home station Program Managers if any student(s) who may require additional training prior to evaluation.

3.3.5. Provide USAF EOS feedback on training needs and student weaknesses observed.

Chapter 4

UNIT ROLES AND RESPONSIBILITIES

4.1. Unit Commanders. The APEX program serves as an Aerial Port/Air Mobility Squadron Commander's port management tool. This tool provides Aerial Port/Air Mobility Squadron commanders with the flexibility to offset workloads during high operations tempo and complex cargo loads specific to AMC Channel missions to include opportune airlift associated with positioning and de-positioning exercise/contingency missions. Unit Aerial Port/Air Mobility Squadron Commanders will:

4.1.1. Appoint a Program Manager to monitor overall APEX program and ensure proper resources are applied. Program Managers will be appointed in writing by the unit commander.

4.1.2. APEX should not impede enlisted career field progression. Personnel assigned to perform APEX functions should continue rotations through other Aerial Port functions to increase overall career field knowledge and abilities without stagnation.

4.2. Unit APEX Program Manager. Program Managers are responsible for the overall management of the unit program, including personnel selection, certification, and currency validation. The Program Managers position will

4.2.1. Be filled by a CGO, SNCO, or civilian/local nationals assigned against an appropriate Standard Core Personnel Document (SCPD) or Position Description (PD). **Note:** They are not required to complete APEX Load Director training or certification.

4.2.2. Collect and evaluate personnel currency records monthly using an AMC approved Excel spreadsheet or the Monthly e346, Currency Log.

4.2.3. Provide a courtesy copy of the Program Manager Appointment letter to HQ AMC/A4TC, via APEX Sharepoint™ or E-mail to **amc.a4tc.apex@us.af.mil** or **AMC.A4TCP@us.af.mil**.

4.2.4. Monitor all certified APEX personnel's quarterly currency requirements.

4.2.5. Upload data to the APEX Sharepoint™ Site, no later than (NLT) five duty days after the end of each calendar month or upon request from HQ AMC/A4TC.

4.2.6. Monitor personnel to ensure refresher training, evaluation and certification requirements are completed.

4.2.7. Certify quarterly currency by completing applicable section of the AMC Form 34, *APEX Load Director Evaluation*.

4.2.7.1. After successful completion of an initial or recurring evaluation, the Program Manager will sign the certification block on the AMC Form 34, certifying the individual as Load Director qualified. **Note:** Per **paragraph 5.2.6**, commanders will certify APEX Standardization and Evaluation (STAN/EVAL) personnel.

4.2.8. Coordinate with HQ AMC/A3V for recurring evaluation of the Primary Unit APEX STAN/EVAL via APEX SharePoint™ or Email. Coordination will be completed NLT the ninth month from the previous evaluation. The Primary Unit APEX STAN/EVAL will conduct evaluations on alternate evaluators for the same airframe.

4.2.9. Collect and evaluate quarterly the number of certified personnel and qualification status. Monitor current and forecasted unit workload to ensure adequate APEX resources are available. Advise unit commander or designated representative on overall health of APEX program.

4.2.10. Collect and analyze trend data to support commander and/or HQ AMC directed metrics and maintain program files.

4.2.11. Conduct an annual APEX unit self-assessment. If Management Internal Control Toolset (MICT) is not available, provide a written report to the unit commander and ensure corrective actions are taken when needed.

4.2.12. Maintain file copies of AMC Form 34 and AMC Form 346, *APEX Quarterly Currency Log*, on the APEX Sharepoint™ Site. Maintain all forms in an active status for one year and in an inactive status for 36 months.

4.2.13. Maintain folders on all assigned APEX Load Directors, folders will include:

4.2.13.1. AMC Form 34 and current refresher *Test Certificate*.

4.2.13.2. Program Manager can insert additional documents at their discretion.

4.2.14. Ensure APEX folder is given to Permanent Change of Station (PCS), deploying, separating, or retiring personnel.

4.2.15. Actively monitor evaluations, training and demand strict compliance with this instruction and future command directives.

4.2.16. Develop local procedures to ensure APEX Load Directors read and acknowledge new Flight Crew Information File (FCIF). A link to the FCIF website is provided in **paragraph 5.3.3**.

4.2.17. APS and AMS units will not use APEX on the following missions:

4.2.17.1. Unit/Local Training (ex. Mission prefixes AUN, QUN, PUN, SUN, etc.)

4.2.17.2. Aeromedical Evacuation

4.2.17.3. Aerial Delivery/Air Drop Cargo

4.2.17.4. Prime Nuclear Airlift Force

4.2.17.5. MAJCOM/Wing/Group Exercises

4.2.17.6. Ground Training Mission

4.2.17.7. Quick-turn missions (Without prior coordination and approval by APS/AMS Leadership)

4.2.18. Self-Assessment programs should include a wide variety of internal assessments or evaluations. At a minimum, commanders must utilize applicable Self- Assessment Communicators (SACs) in MICT. MICT is the Air Force program of record to communicate a unit's current status. SACs are used to:

4.2.18.1. Ask commanders, supervisors, and airmen at all levels of operations to self-report compliance and non-compliance.

4.2.18.2. Improve compliance with published guidance and communicate risk and program health up and down the chain of command in near real-time.

Chapter 5

UNIT APEX STANDARDIZATION AND EVALUATION (STAN/EVAL)

5.1. Unit STAN/EVAL. Personnel designated as the Unit APEX STAN/EVAL are in critical positions at each APEX location and are key to the success of the program. Designated personnel must complete APEX Load Directors training.

5.2. Unit STAN/EVAL Requirements.

5.2.1. Possess Air Force Specialty Code (AFSC) 2T271 or civilian/local nationals assigned against an appropriate SCPD or PD.

5.2.2. Have 24 collective months of APEX experience as a Load Director or Instructor.

5.2.2.1. Units may request a waiver to the 24-month requirement based on an individual's previous qualification. All requests will be coordinated with HQ AMC/A4TC APEX Program Manager. **(T-2)**

5.2.3. Possess knowledge of aircraft limitations and weight and balance computation procedures.

5.2.4. Possess hazardous materials handler qualification or higher, IAW AFMAN 24-604, *Preparing Hazardous Materials for Military Air Shipments*.

5.2.5. Successfully complete an initial evaluation conducted by HQ AMC/A3V or HQ AMC/A3V designated representative. The evaluation will include the evaluator's ability to administer an evaluation to an APEX Load Director. All evaluations will be documented on the AMC Form 34. Maintain all initial AMC Form 34s for all Primary and Alternate STAN/EVAL personnel.

5.2.5.1. The Primary Unit APEX STAN/EVAL must receive recurring evaluations from HQ AMC/A3V or HQ AMC/A3V designated representative.

5.2.5.2. Either HQ AMC/A3V, HQ AMC/A3V designated representative, or the Primary APEX Unit STAN/EVAL can perform recurring evaluations on all Alternate APEX Unit STAN/EVAL personnel between the 10th and 14th month after the previous evaluation.

5.2.5.3. Evaluation will be coordinated with HQ AMC/A3V for each aircraft via APEX SharePoint™ NLT the ninth month from the previous evaluation. The recurring evaluations will be completed between the 10th and 14th month after the previous evaluation. **Note:** In the event a unit STAN/EVAL candidate fails an initial or recurring evaluation, the Program Manager will advise their commander and HQ AMC/A4TC within 10 duty days and advise a course of action. Two consecutive failures will result in the individual's removal from consideration as a unit STAN/EVAL.

5.2.6. Be certified on the AMC Form 34 by the unit commander. Certification will occur after successful completion of refresher training and successful completion of a practical loading evaluation conducted by HQ AMC/A3V or HQ AMC/A3V designated representative. A signed copy of the AMC Form 34 will be forwarded to HQ AMC/A4TC, via APEX Sharepoint™ or E-mail to **amc.a4tc.apex@us.af.mil** or **AMC.A4TCP@us.af.mil**.

5.2.7. Successfully complete an APEX refresher exam annually and maintain the same currency as Load Director personnel.

5.3. Unit STAN/EVAL Duties includes:

5.3.1. Monitor APEX loading operations, personnel proficiency, and performance.

5.3.2. Solve aircraft loading issues and, as necessary, collaborate with HQ AMC/A3V or the locally assigned STAN/EVAL Loadmasters.

5.3.3. Maintain and continually update all publications/checklists required for Load Director personnel and instructors, including FCIF, which are located at: **https://usaf.dps.mil/teams/10370/FCIF/default.aspx** or APEX SharePoint™ Site. STAN/EVAL personnel will ensure sufficient publications are available in a central location for all APEX operations.

5.3.3.1. Ensure Load Directors read and acknowledge new FCIFs prior to any loading activities.

5.3.4. Administer annual recertification and targeted no-notice evaluations to Instructors and Load Directors as directed by the Program Manager and/or HQ AMC/A4TC. Primary Unit APEX STAN/EVAL will conduct evaluations on alternate evaluators for the same airframe. Unit evaluators may take one credit towards their quarterly currency for performing an on-load evaluation.

5.3.5. Conduct a comprehensive pre-evaluation brief and post-evaluation debrief to the examinee on all aspects of the evaluation. Document all practical loading evaluations using the AMC Form 34. Maintain and document quarterly currency for Load Director Instructor and Load Director personnel. Immediately correct breaches of safety during an evaluation. An evaluation will not be changed to avoid documenting substandard performance, nor will training be changed to alter a key evaluation technique. The evaluator may accomplish additional training immediately after the evaluation is complete.

5.3.6. Collect, review, and consolidate AMC Forms 346 and forward to the Program Manager NLT three duty days after the end of the active quarter.

5.3.7. Assist and advise unit instructors with local training plan development.

5.3.8. **Note:** No-notice evaluations may be conducted upon request of HQ AMC/A4TC after coordination with HQ AMC/A3V. They will be conducted by HQ AMC/A3V or HQ AMC/A3V designated evaluators. HQ AMC/A4TC will coordinate with the Program Manager NLT 24 hours prior to the evaluation.

5.3.9. **Note:** Dual qualified STAN/EVAL (C-17, C-5) personnel should only be appointed to address short-term personnel shortfalls and in such cases, they may be the Primary STAN/EVAL for only one airframe.

5.3.10. **Note:** Individuals can fill both Unit APEX STAN/EVAL and Instructor roles for the same aircraft type as long as the STAN/EVAL who is performing an initial evaluation is not the same person who instructed the trainee.

Chapter 6

UNIT APEX LOAD DIRECTOR INSTRUCTORS

6.1. Unit APEX Load Director Instructor will:

6.1.1. Possess AFSC 2T271, appropriate SCPD for civilians, or appropriate PD for Local Nationals. Individuals selected for unit instructor duties must be highly qualified military or civilian Aerial Port personnel. Load Director Instructor may be a primary duty at some APEX locations.

6.1.2. Possess 12 months of cumulative APEX Load Director experience.

6.1.3. Complete the AETC-sponsored course, Principles of Instruction (POI), which is recommended, but not mandatory for selection.

6.1.4. Possess hazardous materials handler qualification or higher, IAW AFMAN 24-604.

6.1.5. Complete refresher training requirements and maintain currency the same as Load Director personnel.

6.1.6. Successfully pass an annual evaluation conducted by unit STAN/EVAL for each type aircraft. No-notice proficiency evaluations may be performed upon request of unit commander, Program Manager, or HQ AMC/A4TC.

6.2. Unit APEX Load Director Instructors Duties:

6.2.1. Conduct practical aircraft and classroom instruction as well as any remedial training with unqualified APEX Load Directors.

6.2.2. Draft and maintain unit training plans for hands-on-training.

6.2.3. Complete the same formal, practical and refresher training as Load Director personnel.

Chapter 7

UNIT APEX LOAD DIRECTORS

7.1. Unit APEX Load Directors Requirements.

7.1.1. Maintain control and accountability for all on/offload operations IAW technical orders, AMC instructions and other applicable guidance.

7.1.2. Possess a AFSC 2T251 skill level (minimum rank of SrA) or civilian equivalent.

7.1.3. Possess six months of qualification time as an aircraft load team chief.

7.1.4. Possess hazardous materials handler qualification or higher, IAW AFMAN 24-604.

7.1.5. Complete USAF EOS formal two-week classroom training on respective aircraft.

7.1.6. Following the USAF EOS formal two-week class, complete respective aircraft 30-hr Hands-on training.

7.1.7. Successfully complete initial and recurring practical loading evaluation conducted by unit STAN/EVAL personnel, for each aircraft. Evaluations will be conducted based on AMC Form 34.

7.1.7.1. Accomplish practical loading evaluations NLT 60 calendar days following completion of all formal training requirements. Trainees not evaluated within 60 calendar days of formal training require an extension granted from HQ AMC/A4TC. Extensions will require full justification and commander validation outlining reasons the initial evaluation was not completed within the prescribed time frame. Those personnel who receive extension approval but do not accomplish the evaluation within 90 calendar days of formal training may be considered for withdrawal from the APEX program.

7.1.7.2. Individuals that fail the initial evaluation will receive remedial training in the deficient area. Remedial training and supervision will be conducted by unit instructors immediately following evaluation failure. Individuals may perform APEX loading under supervision of the instructor or unit STAN/EVAL during remedial period. Upon completion of remedial training, the individual will receive a second evaluation on all areas but focused on deficient areas.

7.1.7.3. In the event of a second failure, the Program Manager will determine the appropriate course of action.

7.1.8. Load Directors must annually complete and pass the web-based course exam and practical evaluation. Evaluations must occur between the 10th and 14th month following the last successful evaluation. **Note:** Load Directors are subject to no-notice evaluations, or task specific evaluations by the Primary or Alternate Unit STAN/EVAL. The no-notice evaluation will not replace the requirement for an annual evaluation. Avoid administering no-notice evaluations within the 10th and 14th month for the intended evaluation unless Unit Program Manager directed.

7.1.9. Successfully complete three aircraft on or offload biannually, to maintain currency. Loads validated for currency will consist of two or more pallets and/or rolling stock and require a full pre-flight check of the aircraft. The AMCI 24-6051V1_CL-1, *C-17 Aerial Port*

Expeditor (APEX) Load Director Checklist; AMCI 24-6051V1_CL-2, *C-5 Aerial Port Expeditor (APEX) Load Director Checklist;* and AMCI 24-6051V1_CL-3, *C-17 Aerial Port Expeditor (APEX) Load Director Checklist* is mandatory for all loading operations (on-/offloads). Currency must be maintained to retain certification.

7.1.10. Successfully complete a unit STAN/EVAL supervised on-load immediately following the quarter in which currency requirements are not met. Annotate results on the AMC Form 34.

7.1.11. Annotate on AMC Form 346 upon completion of the on/offload. **Note:** Once a Load Director becomes non-current for any period not to exceed 24 months, Program Manager, and unit STAN/EVAL will determine the appropriate course of action to bring member back to APEX Load Director qualified status. Once a Load Director is 24 months to 36 months non-current, the Squadron Commander in coordination with the Program Manager will determine appropriate action to bring member back to APEX Load Director qualified status. Once a member has been non-current for longer than 36 months, the member must be completely retrained.

7.1.12. Annotate on the AMC Form 346 when a Load Directors are deployed/TDY/Leave for an extended periods over 6 months. A waiver is not required. The Load Director will perform a load immediately upon returning to duty.

7.2. Unit APEX Load Director Duties.

7.2.1. Read and acknowledge new FCIFs prior to any loading activities.

7.2.2. Coordinate with Air Terminal Operations Center (ATOC) and maintenance to ensure aircraft has power and correct aircraft configuration. Inspect aircraft cargo compartment and preflight rail system IAW the applicable aircraft checklist. Report any discrepancies to the maintenance crew chief for entry on AFTO Form 781K, Aerospace Vehicle Inspection, Engine Data, Calendar Inspection and Delayed Discrepancy Document

7.2.3. Check calculated aircraft limitations and aircraft weight and balance computations. Inform/coordinate load adjustments with ATOC/Load Planning, annotate corrections on manual/Integrated Computerized Deployment System (ICODES) load plan and sign as "Loaded By (*signature*)". Do not load aircraft until the Allowable Cabin Load (ACL) is verified.

7.2.4. Notify ATOC when load complications prohibit aircraft loading as planned.

7.2.5. Maintain positive control of all loading personnel in the aircraft vicinity while supervising the on/offload operations.

7.2.6. Provide loading capabilities for C-5 or C-17 aircraft in any configuration and type of cargo.

7.2.7. Maintain effective communication with maintenance and load team during on/offload operations. This may also require an effective land mobile radio network and/or aircraft interphone capability.

7.2.8. Coordinate with ATOC to ensure a qualified maintenance individuals are available to connect cargo requiring venting to the aircraft overboard venting system.

7.2.9. Delay loading of classified material and/or registered mail until the mission Loadmaster is available to accept custody, unless DOD constant surveillance can be provided until crew show time.

7.2.10. Ensure perishable cargo is not loaded if a risk of destruction due to re-icing or refrigeration limitations exists. Relevant re-icing criteria will be factored into all loading decisions by APEX Load Directors, ATOC, and Duty Officer.

7.2.11. Perform stabilizer strut operating procedures along with operating the door and ramp as required for the purpose of on/offloading C-17 aircraft.

7.2.12. Ensure aircraft is loaded utilizing the actual operating weight and moment when available. **Note:** Actual or standardized operating weights and moments may be utilized to calculate Zero Fuel Weight Center of Balance. **Note:** Load Directors have overall control until relieved by the outbound Loadmaster(s). A coordination briefing is required prior to the Loadmaster assuming overall control.

7.2.13. **Note:** Load Directors will not perform simultaneous duties to include load team chief or load team member responsibilities during APEX operations.

7.3. Checklists. Checklists are a pivotal instrument for safety and training which will require continual review by unit STAN/EVAL personnel. Two loading checklists exist, appended, and expanded; both are applicable to all ground loading operations. During daily operations APEX personnel will use, as a minimum, AMCI 24-6051V1_CL-1, CL-2, or CL-3 to ensure required APEX loading actions are accomplished. These checklists are derived from applicable -1 and -9 Technical Orders. When conflicts occur between checklists and the aircraft technical orders, the technical orders always take precedence. See AMCI 24-6051V1_CL-1, AMCI 24-6051V1_CL-2 and AMCI 24-6051V1_CL-3.

Chapter 8

SUPPORTING RESPONSIBILITIES

8.1. ATOC/DO Responsibilities. ATOC/DO will:

8.1.1. Coordinate with local command and control, ramp services and maintenance controllers to establish aircraft on/offload times.

8.1.2. Ensure all APEX on/offloading is completed NLT the original schedule of events (SOE) load times.

8.1.3. ATOC/DO will ensure loading/unloading is not directed until aircraft are cleared or released by maintenance. Coordinate with maintenance personnel prior to loading any aircraft that is not fully mission capable and provide aircraft configuration requirements for upload.

8.1.4. APEX loading is based on mission requirements and Aerial Port workload factors, not aircrew preference.

8.2. Aircraft Maintenance Responsibilities. Maintenance will:

8.2.1. Support at designated bases and locations where APEX operations will be performed is critical to the success of the program.

8.2.2. Release aircraft for loading to ATOC. An aircraft released for on/offloading indicates maintenance work on the aircraft is not planned or presently underway hampering loading operations.

8.2.3. Ensure aircraft configuration meets ATOC requirements prior to release for loading.

8.2.4. Apply, maintain and monitor power to the aircraft by Ground Power Unit (GPU) or Aircraft Power Unit (APU).

8.2.5. Operate aircraft systems as required and monitor safety.

8.2.6. Maintain communication capability with Load Director during loading operations.

8.2.7. Supervise all evacuation operations in the event of an aircraft systems or petroleum, oil, and lubricants (POL)-related ground emergency. The aircraft maintainer and/or Load Director will stop all loading operations when an unsafe condition exists.

8.3. Loadmaster Responsibilities. Loadmasters will:

8.3.1. Accept a load based on applicable -9 Technical Orders, not personal preference.

8.3.2. Compute the DD Form 365-4, *Weight and Balance Clearance Form F,* also referred to as the—Form F.

8.3.3. Unless pre-coordinated with ATOC during inbound aircraft call, Loadmasters are responsible for on/offloading their own quick turn aircraft.

8.3.4. When aircrew training or evaluations are required, ATOC will be informed on inbound call that APEX is not necessary.

8.3.5. APEX loading is based on mission requirements and Aerial Port workload factors, not aircrew preference.

Chapter 9

DEPLOYED APEX PROGRAM MANAGEMENT

9.1. Deployment Requirements.

9.1.1. HQ AMC/A4TC will coordinate with the deployed site leadership on the number of APEX certified personnel required to successfully accomplish a deployed APEX program.

9.1.2. HQ AMC/A4OL will ensure the correct information is included in the tasking to support deployed APEX locations.

9.1.3. Personnel selected to perform deployed APEX Load Director duties must meet all currency requirements prior to their departure and ensure currency for the duration of deployment.

9.1.4. Deployed APEX Load Directors will have electronic access and/or hand carry their AMC Form 346, AMC Form 34, APEX checklists and all appropriate safety gear to carry out their APEX responsibilities.

9.1.5. All paperwork given to APEX Program Managers at deployed locations should be kept on file for the duration of the individual's deployment.

9.1.6. Deployed Load Directors will possess the capability to load aircraft at their new location after sufficient flight line orientation actions are completed.

9.1.7. This is an AMC specific program; the determination of future deployment policies and locations related to APEX personnel will be determined by HQ AMC/A4T. **Note:** Deployed APEX Program Managers will notify deployed Load Directors of any APEX messages or FCIFs updates. In the event an evaluation is required and no STAN/EVAL personnel are available, coordinate with HQ AMC/A4TC APEX Program Manager for waiver authority or if required an evaluation from HQ AMC/A3V. **(T-2)**

ANTHONY D. BABCOCK, Brigadier General, USAF
Director of Logistics, Engineering and Force Protection

Attachment 1

GLOSSARY OF REFERENCES AND SUPPORTING INFORMATION

References

AFMAN 24-604*, Preparing Hazardous Materials for Military Air Shipments*, 9 October 2020

AMCI 24-6051V1_CL-1, *C-17 Aerial Port Expeditor (APEX) Load Director Checklist*

AMCI 24-6051V1_CL-2, *C- 5 Aerial Port Expeditor (APEX) Load Director Checklist*

AMCI 24-6051V1_CL-3, *C-17 Aerial Port Expeditor (APEX) Load Director Checklist*

TO 1C-5A-9, *Loading Instructions Manual*, 22 October 2024

TO 1C-17A-9*, Loading Instructions Manual*, 1 July 2024

Prescribed Forms

AMC Form 34, *APEX Load Director Evaluation*

AMC Form 346, *APEX Quarterly Currency Log*

Adopted Forms

AFTO Form 781K, Aerospace Vehicle Inspection, Engine Data, Calendar Inspection and Delayed Discrepancy Document

DAF Form 847, *Recommendation for Change of Publication*

DD Form 365-4, *Weight and Balance Clearance Form F*

Abbreviations and Acronyms

ACL—Allowable Cabin Load

AFMAN—Air Force Manual

AFSC—Air Force Specialty Code

AMC—Air Mobility Command

AMCI—Air Mobility Command Instruction

APEX—Aerial Port Expeditor

APU—Aircraft Power Unit

ATOC—Air Terminal Operations Center

CGO—Company Grade Officer

DAFMAN—Department of the Air Force Manual

DAFPD—Department of the Air Force Policy Directive

DOD—Department of Defense

FCIF—Fight Crew Information Files

GPU—Ground Power Unit

IAW—In Accordance With

ICODES—Integrated Computerized Deployment System

MICT—Management Internal Control Toolset

MTT—Mobile Training Team

NLT—Not Later Than

OPR—Office of Primary Responsibility

PCS—Permanent Change of Station

PD—Position Description

PNAF—Prime Nuclear Airlift Force

POI—Principles of Instruction

POL—petroleum, oil, and lubricants

SAC—Self- Assessment Communicators

SCPD—Standard Core Personnel Document

STAN/EVAL—Standardization and Evaluation

USAF EOS—USAF Expeditionary Operations School

Office Symbols

HQ AMC/A3V—Headquarters Air Mobility Command Aircrew Standardization Evaluation Division

HQ AMC/A4M—Headquarters Air Mobility Command Directorate of Logistics Maintenance Division

HQ AMC/A4T—Headquarters Air Mobility Command Air Transportation Division

HQ AMC/A4TC—Headquarters Air Mobility Command Air Cargo Movement Policy Branch

HQ AMC/A4TS—Headquarters Air Mobility Command Standardization and Resources Branch